sitting in the wrong country! He was convinced, though, that India already had a respectable amount of soft power and could develop its attractiveness further. He did not essay a comparison with China, but it was the 'dragon' in the room.

Five years later, Parama Sinha Palit published a book comparing Indian and Chinese soft power and came to a rather different conclusion from Tharoor.[30] Palit assiduously tracked Chinese soft power initiatives in every region of the world and then cast a briefer look at Indian efforts. Included in her view of soft power are high-level visits, various forms of economic assistance and cooperation including infrastructure and connectivity projects, cultural and public diplomacy, and education cooperation and outreach. In her wide-ranging and sober assessment, she concluded the following: 'India, despite being compared incessantly with China, is yet to command a similar global pull . . . China is engaging the world on a much bigger scale and faster pace than India . . . The sheer scale of China's initiatives dwarfs those of India . . . While not emulating Chinese initiatives in size, the "visibility" quotient of India's soft power is likely to become larger over time.'[31]

India's and China's Soft Power Measured

Joseph Nye suggests we can assess India's and China's soft power in three broad dimensions: foreign policy influence; cultural influence; and political influence. The foreign policy dimension asks how others see a country's foreign policy – is its conduct regarded as legitimate and moral? The cultural dimension asks whether others are attracted to or respect another country's culture (high or classical culture, popular culture, its heritage sites, its brands, etc.). The political values/institutions dimension asks to what extent others are attracted to or respect, even emulate, another society's political system (democracy, justice, governance, etc.).

The great difficulty of estimating and comparing soft power is that in the end it requires information on the perceptions and then behaviour of people.